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SHOOTING IS GOING TO GROW IMMENSELY IN INDIA BECAUSE WE ARE NATURALLY DISCIPLINED AND POSSESS GREAT KNOWLEDGE OF FOCUS, MEDITATION, AND YOGA

much. I love sports. And as long as someone loves what they do, I don't think it's difficult for them to return to it. I was waiting for this. I wanted to resume competitive shooting."

It never seemed as if Manu had been away for seven months as she breezed through February's open selection trials to comfortably secure a spot on the Indian team headed to Argentina and Peru for the season-opening ISSF World Cups in April.

Having recorded the best qualifying average (based on the top four scores in 13 designated competitions) in the 25m sports pistol, she placed second in the 10m

air pistol behind Suruchi Singh, who hails from a neighbouring village in Haryana.

Her cheerful demeanour outside the range stands in stark contrast to her focussed, no-nonsense approach within it. She flits between these alternating personas with remarkable ease.

"I am generally a happy, positive

person. But I do sulk a lot as well. My friends help me come out of it. However, when I'm at the range, if someone disrupts my training, it really annoys me."

When the conversation shifts to Indian shooting, Manu listens intently before adding: "Shooting is going to grow immensely in India because we are naturally disciplined